

Cybercrime Reporting in Pakistan

Preserve first, respond safely

The Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act, 2016 (PECA), as amended, covers several online offences. This guide is for evidence preservation and official reporting, not legal advice.

- Do not pay an extortionist or threaten an account holder.
- Save the original URL, username, date, time, and platform.
- Change passwords, enable multi-factor authentication, and secure linked email.

Evidence checklist

Make files verifiable

Digital evidence can disappear or be challenged if altered.

- Capture full-screen screenshots showing the account, URL, and timestamp.
- Export emails and download original files with metadata where available.
- Keep a simple evidence log: item, source, date collected, and storage location.

Report through the right channel

National cybercrime reporting

The National Cyber Crime Investigation Agency (NCCIA) is the current federal reporting channel for cybercrime matters. Use its official portal or designated office and verify contact details before submitting sensitive data.

- Include a concise chronology, harm, suspect identifiers, and evidence index.
- Keep the complaint reference and copies of every attachment.
- For immediate physical danger, contact local emergency services first.

Account and financial safety

Limit ongoing harm

Contact your bank or payment provider quickly about unauthorised transactions. Ask platforms to preserve or remove abusive content through their reporting tools.

- Freeze cards or tokens and change recovery details.
- Tell trusted contacts if an impersonation account is messaging them.
- Do not install remote-access software at an unknown person's request.

Official sources and reminder

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- Pakistan Code, Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act, 2016:
<https://pakistancode.gov.pk/pdf/files/administrator6a061efe0ed5bd153fa8b79b8eb4cba7.pdf>
- NCCIA: <https://complaint.nccia.gov.pk/>

Verify the current agency, portal, and PECA text before filing. Educational information only.